10,000) at the initiative of C. Vijayaraghavachari.[123] The company also took a loan of Rs 20,000 from the Mylapore Fund.[124] All this amounted to considerably less than half of the authorized capital of Rs 20 lakh. Though a decent amount, it was far from adequate.

As of August 1908, Rs 8 lakh worth of shares had been allotted and over 47,000 shares—7,000 odd shares from the initial authorized capital and 40,000 from the newly authorized capital—remained to be taken.[125]

As noted above, due to the sympathy aroused by VOC's conviction in July 1908, the sale of shares witnessed a spike.[126] However, this cut both ways: while his name was an asset, it also gave the impression—admittedly justified—that the company was completely reliant on VOC's name if not his entrepreneurial skills. *Swadesamitran* tried to disabuse people of this idea, pointing out that S.D. Krishna Aiyangar excelled in every aspect: education, character, integrity and patriotism.[127]

The company had raised the bulk of the capital—a little over Rs 6 lakh of the initially authorized 10 lakh—during the initial years of the company, under VOC's leadership. In the year after VOC's imprisonment, the vigorous campaign raised barely Rs 1,50,000. The proposal in the later part of 1908 to double the authorized capital, elicited only a tepid response. At best, it enabled the company to issue more shares, realizing smaller sums on initial allotment. (Table 8.1)

An intractable problem was that a good quarter of the shareholders did not pay up fully—or rather, paid only Rs 5 on each share at the time of allotment.[128] We can only speculate about the reason. With the company not doing well, probably, some shareholders did not want to put in good money after bad. Haji Fakir Muhammed Sait fell in this category.[129]A major defaulter, his concerns were monetary, prompted by fear of incurring government displeasure. M.V. Maya Nadar, a founding director, too committted the same error of omission though his concerns were about the social orientation of the Swadeshi movement. But it was probable that many of the defaulters did not have the resources to afford the shares in the first place and had subscribed in an initial flush of patriotic enthusiasm. The